Yoshiki Wiskamp

Department of Economics
London School of Economics and Political Science
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DOCTORAL STUDIES

London School of Economics and Political Science 2021–2027
PhD in Economics. MRes completed in 2023 with Distinction.

REFERENCES

Gharad Bryan
London School of Economics
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Robin Burgess
London School of Economics
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Daniel Sturm
London School of Economics
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Oriana Bandiera
London School of Economics
o.bandiera@lse.ac.uk

PRIOR EDUCATION

London School of Economics and Political Science 2020–2021
MSc in Economics. *Distinction*.

Goethe University Frankfurt 2016–2020
BSc in Economics and Business Administration. *Final grade: 1.0*

University of Tokyo 2018/19
Visiting Student.

RESEARCH FIELDS

Spatial Economics, Environmental Economics (primary)
Development Economics (secondary)

JOB MARKET PAPER

Channeling Density: Sewers in 19th-Century Paris
with Ignacio Banares-Sanchez

Coming soon

WORKING PAPER

Trading Trash on Tricycles
with Ignacio Banares-Sanchez
Best Student Paper at the 2026 Urban Economics Association European Meeting

Abstract: Urbanisation generates powerful agglomeration benefits but also severe congestion externalities that require regulation and public goods provision. In developing megacities, governments lack the fiscal and enforcement capacity to implement textbook solutions. In their absence, unregulated private provision emerges across sectors such as waste, sanitation, water, and transport, leaving externalities largely unaddressed. What can economics offer cities that cannot implement textbook policies? We study whether limited, feasible regulation can leverage informal markets to deliver public services at scale, focusing on trash collection in Accra, Ghana. Using novel data, we document an imperfect but functioning market: households pay informal tricycle collectors for door-to-door collection, yet prices remain too high for universal access, and final disposal occurs largely at illegal dumpsites. We identify a single feasible policy lever—subsidies for formal, environmentally controlled disposal—and evaluate it using a new structural model of urban waste collection and disposal. To estimate the model, we combine survey experiments to elicit household demand, a custom app to record transactions and tricycle routes, and a field experiment randomising dumping fees. Counterfactual results show that a modest subsidy achieves roughly 80% of the efficient outcome, substantially reducing environmental damages while generating larger welfare gains at lower cost than planned infrastructure expansion. These findings demonstrate that even in very low-capacity environments, limited price-based regulation can align informal private initiative with social objectives.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Golden Traps: Self-Reinforcing Dynamics of Artisanal Mining
with Sreevidya Ayyar and Hemawathy Balarama

POLICY WORK

Urban Water and Sanitation Systems: Managing Infrastructure, Institutions and Access
with Ignacio Banares-Sanchez, Mikey Blake, Victoria Delbridge, and Edward Glaeser
IGC Synthesis Paper, 2026

Policy Options for Expanding Urban Water and Sanitation
with Ignacio Banares-Sanchez, Mikey Blake, Victoria Delbridge, and Edward Glaeser
IGC Policy Toolkit, 2026

RESEARCH GRANTS

Structural Transformation and Economic Growth, Research Grant (£15,000) 2026
International Growth Center, Research Grant (£100,000) 2025
European Space Agency, Network of Resources Sponsorship (€5,000) 2024
International Growth Center, Research Grant (£30,000) 2024
STICERD LSE, PhD Research Grant (£5,000) 2024
International Growth Center, Small Project Fund (£20,000) 2023

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

Best Student Paper, Urban Economics Association European Meeting 2026
LSE Economics Department Scholarship 2021–2026
German Academic Scholarship Foundation (*Studienstiftung*) 2019–2023
Graduate Scholarship, German Academic Exchange Service (*DAAD*) 2020–2021
PROMOS Scholarship, German Academic Exchange Service (*DAAD*) 2018–2019
German National Scholarship, Goethe University Frankfurt 2018

CONFERENCES

European Meeting of the Urban Economics Association, LSE Environment Week, EEE Mini-Conference on Climate Inequalities 2026
Selected presentations by co-author: NBER Summer Institute EEE 2026, BSE Summer Forum Development 2026, CEPR Conference on Urban and Regional Economics 2025

WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Intern, Halle Institute for Economic Research 2020
Project: Climate Resilient Economic Development in Vietnam

Research Assistant to Michael Binder, Goethe University Frankfurt 2019–2020
Chair for International Macroeconometrics and Macroeconometrics

TEACHING

Online Development Economics Course (IZA/FCDO G^{2}LM|LIC, IGC) 2025–2026

EC307 Development Economics (LSE) 2024–2026
TA for Oriana Bandiera & Robin Burgess · Evaluations: 4.7, 4.8, 4.9 out of 5

EC2A3 Microeconomics II (LSE) 2023–2024
TA for Dimitra Petropoulou · Evaluation: 4.8/5

EC1B3 Macroeconomics I (LSE) 2022–2024
TA for Antonio Mele · Evaluations: 4.9, 4.8 out of 5

EC1A3 Microeconomics I (LSE) 2022–2023
TA for Ronny Razin · Evaluation: 4.8/5

SKILLS

LaTeX, Matlab, Python, QGIS, R, Stata

PERSONAL

Residency: German (citizen), Japanese (citizen), UK (pre-settled)
Languages: English (fluent), German (native), Japanese (fluent)

October 2026